MOUNTAINEER
SPRING 2000

NEIGHBOR TO NEIGHBOR

Greetings neighbors from Leila and Emmette Keese. In case we haven't met, our site on the mountainside is K-7, also known as Gold Hill, which we purchased in 1988. That means we've had twelve years worth of good times with many of you and shared some of the growing pains and squabbles too. For many years we could always be found somewhere around the mountainside on week-ends as we relaxed from the pressures of our jobs and teen-aged children.

Initially Emmette was working long and hard on the Global Position System (GPS) for IBM while Leila labored teaching seniors to love the likes of Chaucer and "Gentle Will" Shakespeare. Presently, Emmette is with Lockheed Martin and Leila has moved up to management - home management that is. In addition, we are actively involved in civic affairs in our beloved town of Washington Grove, MD. In fact, that involvement has often kept us from our Coolfont week-ends in recent years.

Our lives on the mountainside have been incredibly enriched by the friendships we've formed as we've seen a real community spirit emerge. Our neighbors, the Connors, have become family, as have the Waters, the Shushansians, and the Bigelows. On special occasions we catch up with many of the members of CMA that we have gotten to know.

On a sadder note, together we have mourned the death of two outstanding CMA Presidents - Jim Bradfield and Lee Weinberger, whom we miss dearly.

Well, neighbors, you can tell we love Coolfont. Of course we are always refreshed and grateful for the natural beauty and serenity of the mountains; but it is the friendships which have made the difference. Drop by Gold Hill if you have a chance and say hello.

BOY, I'VE LEARNED A LOT!

Those of you who were here four years ago when I took over doing the newsletter may remember what it looked like. It was the first time I had ever done anything like that and it certainly was a learning experience. I'm not the type of person that follows a book to learn, so it was pretty much trial and error in the beginning. But through perserverance, and a lot of swearing and threatening to throw the computer out the window, I learned. I also learned a lot about the people of CMA. I learned who I could count on for getting me articles on time and who needed a gentle, or sometimes hard push. I believe we learned more about the members of the community through The Neighbor to Neighbor column that I originated.

I will be happy to help in the beginning whoever decides to take over the Mountaineer. Don't be afraid, it's not as hard as you may think. The hardest part is getting some of the people to write the articles. But it's fun and rewarding. Thanks to all of you for your nice compliments on the Mountaineer for the last four years.

Mary Ann

CMA TO BE SPRAYED

Thanks to Treasurer Paul Kagen for arranging this.

One day during the first two weeks in May don't be alarmed if you see a low flying plane over the mountainside spraying a chemical for the suppression of Gypsy Moths. CMA is participating in an area wide project of the West Virginia Department of Agriculture to keep the Gypsy Moth population under control.

The Gypsy Moth is one of the most notorious pests of hardwood trees in the eastern United States. In 1981 Gypsy Moths defoliated an area larger than Rhode Island, Massachusetts and Connecticut combined. If not controlled, they could denude the mountainside in a very short time.

The chemical that will be sprayed is Dimilin. Dimilin is an alternative insecticide for Gypsy Moth suppression and eradication projects in infested areas. It is also effective against many other predatory forest insects. Because of the extremely low application rate, it is highly unlikely that a health hazard to humans would occur, and studies have shown no treatment related effects on soil microbes, small mammals, birds and honey bees. It is considered to have a very low environmental impact.

The West Virginia Department of Agriculture reports that a single application of very low dosage, when applied against young caterpillars, can provide effective foliage protection and multi-year reduction in Gypsy Moth levels.

If you would like further information, contact the West Virginia Department of Agriculture, Plant Industries Division, Gypsy Moth Program at 304-558-2212 in Charleston or the Morgan County Extension Office in Berkeley Springs.

PRESIDENT'S REPORT

Frank Rutherford

Over the past few months the board had been working on several projects that are important to the Association. Believe it or not, we have filed with the PSC for a reduction in the water and sewer rates. The PSC has inspected our operation and our books. The next step in the process is for the commission to make a recommendation for a specific rate reduction. This, we hope, will not be the last reduction. Once we finish the remaining minor capital improvements, we should be able to file for another rate reduction.

We continue to pursue plans to build a structure at the pool. We have been through several plans trying to keep the project within the limit of the budget. Our current thinking is to combine the pool house and barn office into one structure. This structure would have two sections; one to house the association records and files, and the other would be the bathroom and changing area. If all goes well, we could have a building by the end of the year.

In the next few weeks we will be mailing two ballots to the membership to vote for changes in the covenants and in the regulations that govern the use of the property for business. These are important votes so please return the ballot promptly.

SECURITY REPORT

We are in the process of re-negotiating our security contract with CRI. Our hope is to continue to provide evening patrols seven nights a week. Once the contract is formalized, we will provide you with phone numbers to contact for different situations.

NOMINATING COMMITTEE

At the annual meeting in July we will need to elect three new board members. If you have any suggestions of an individual who you feel would be a good board member, please contact a current board member with the name.

RECREATION COMMITTEE

Elaine Anderson

The Recreation Committee continues its work on the pool bathhouse and CMA office project. An architect has been retained and a topo map has been provided to the architect and prospective builder for their information. A site review is being done in the pool area as originally proposed. The proposed structure will be one story and will comply with handicap access regulations. Hopefully, the project will proceed. Elmer Broxson was designated the liaison with the Washington based architect. This should help expedite the process. Season pool passes will soon be prepared and mailed to members. The tennis courts will be open. A sign in sheet will be provided this season. I want to thank every member of CMA who helped me in every project during the past two years. I will be leaving the Board at the end of this term and thank you for your support.

COMMUNICATION/SOCIAL COMMITTEE

Rosemary Bigelow

After a three month hiatus, the community got together in March for its first pot luck in the new millennium It was lots of fun and everyone seemed happy to be together again. Check out the board meeting and pot luck schedule listed elsewhere in the newsletter and join us for the next get together. From June through September, we will hold our pot lucks in the barn. However, we still need volunteers to host these pot lucks. Anyone willing to set up the barn for one of these get togethers, please contact me at 304-258-5352.

Following CMA's Annual Meeting on July 22, there will be a community dinner at the barn. Elmer Broxson has again agreed to head the committee to plan the evening. We will begin with a cocktail hour with wine and hors d'oeuvres provided by the committee; followed by a catered dinner. The cost per member will be $15 for adults and $8 for children under 12. Please RSVP and send your check to Elmer Broxson no later then July 1. Do plan to come; last year we had 85 people in attendance. It's a great way to meet and socialize with your CMA neighbors.

We have a tradition of holding open houses on the Sunday morning following the annual meeting. New members or members who have recently built a home have a chance to share their new "digs" with the rest of the community. So, if you would like to hold an open house, please contact me. We'll let everyone know at the annual meeting where open houses will be held

CMA is part of the larger community of Berkeley Springs, which helps to create this place we all love and it seems appropriate that we give back in some small way to that community. I am proposing for the 2001 budget that CMA set aside a fund to make contributions to local community organizations and causes e.g. Humane Society, Telescope Foundation etc. Please let the board know if you are supportive of such a fund.

After four years of tireless effort, Mary Ann Siushansian, will be retiring as newsletter editor after this issue. Many, many thanks Mary Ann for doing a wonderful job. We really need volunteers to take over the production of the newsletter so we can continue to keep up with what's happening on the Mountainside. Please call me and say you'll help.

DID YOU KNOW

Tari's in Berkeley Springs has expanded and added a new and larger dining room, leaving a smaller room for private functions or more intimate dining, She can work up a special menu for groups, even brunch. And to add to the fun, she has added a "Wild Woman" Gift Shop, featuring West Virginia women artists.

Try taking a short trip to Rock Gap Lodge and Conference Center, located on I 68, about 5 miles this side of Cumberland. Besides golf, there is a very nice restaurant in the Conference Center overlooking the water. It's open year-round and serves three meals a day and brunch from 11am to 2pm every Sunday. They also have special holiday buffets, 301-784-8444.

A couple of miles closer to Cumberland there is another good restaurant called JB's Steak Cellar. They are known for their beef dishes and are always packed so make reservations, 301-722-6155.

DACC COMMITTEE

Richard Kaufman

The work of the DACC is mandated by the covenants and the by-laws of the association. The covenants to the properties on the mountainside state that all buildings, fences or other structures or changes and additions to these structures, must be approved by an architectural committee, as to harmony of external design and location in relation to surrounding structures and topography. The by-laws require this committee to review all plans for improvements and determine that they are consistent with the covenants, the building guidelines and the Regulations and Guideline Regarding the Use of Property.

Over the past year, the members of the committee have followed our mandate as set out in the covenants and by-laws, to assure that the mountainside continues to develop in ways that preserve the environment and values of the community.

We are pleased to report that we continue to receive excellent cooperation from all those who have undertaken new construction, or improvement projects. It has been a busy year and we expect to see more activity in the coming months. One new home is presently nearing completion at R-8. Construction of a home at R-7 was recently begin and a request to build a home at I-3 has been approved. As of this writing, another request to build a home is pending. According to Sam Ashelman, lots in the new T Section will soon be placed on the market. In addition, several home improvement projects, including the replacement of exterior siding the addition of decks, and in one instance, the addition of a room, have been approved. The committee has also acted on several requests to remove dead trees.

REAL ESTATE COMMISSION UPHOLDS CMA HOMEOWNERS

The West Virginia Real Estate Commission has issued a ruling in the form of a consent decree that protects CMA homeowners who employ outside real estate brokers to sell their homes. The Commission concluded that it was improper for the Coolfont real estate broker to tell CMA homeowners Kitty and Gale Connor, that if they listed their home through an outside broker, any subsequent purchaser would not be eligible to participate in the Coolfont rental program.

BOARD MEETINGS

April 29 board meeting at Joan Bradfields - pot luck at Dick and Eva Lehman's
May 27 board meeting at Joan Bradfield's - pot luck at Lon and Janice Dring's
June 17 board meeting at Joan Bradfield's - pot luck at the barn
July 22 board meeting at 9am at Coolfont Treetop
July 22 annual meeting at Treetop

CMA WATER AND SEWER RATES COMING DOWN SOON

Paul Kagen

The Public Service Commission of WV is currently considering a proposal to reduce CMA water and sewer rates by almost 17.5%. The new rates of $17 per thousand gallons for water and $2 per thousand gallons for sewer were requested by the CMA Board and have been supported by the staff of the PSC after a detailed audit of our books and physical inspection of our water and sewer plant. As you know, the present rate is $23 per thousand gallons. Both the accounting and engineering staff reports praised the operation of our water and sewer facilities. The proceeding is now pending before an Administrative Law Judge and a decision is anticipated in the very near future.

The staff proposal also includes other changes in our water and sewer policies, including an adjustment in our extraordinary and unusual usage policy, which would provide for a larger adjustment in the event of a major leak problem. We have been reminded that leaks are the responsibility of the individual home owners and the adjustment policy will only apply to extraordinary and unusual usage which exceeds twice the normal usage.

The staff has proposed that late charges be levied on all invoices not paid within 20 days, rather than the current 30 day policy. The new policy is proposed to be effective at the time the new rates are first billed.

In a determined effort to proceed cautiously to avoid any possible damage to our fiscal integrity, the Board considers the pending rate reduction to be a first step toward bringing the rates down to a lower level. Encouraged by the PSC staff, it is anticipated that the second step in the rate reduction program will be filed with the PSC after the proposed rates have been in effect for one year.

HOUSES AND LOTS FOR SALE

FOR SALE BY OWNER:

K-5 Bear's Den Gale & Kitty Connor $235,000
304-258-3975

K-14 Lot Dick & Eva Lehman $45,000
301-229-3274

THROUGH KESECKER REALTY (304-258-2200)

A-2 Lot Milton & Barbara Glatt $22,000
202-363-7998

THROUGH SNYDER, BAILEY & ASSOCIATES (Martha Ashelman 304-258-9148)

H-1 Lot Joyce Simons $39,900
H-5 Lot Don & Carol Green $33,000
K-1 & K-2 Lots Michael & Barbara Ankrum $78,000 (K-1 $42,500, K-2 $38,000)
K-12 Lot Richard & Jeanne Buchanan & Jim & Marie Chaney $36,900
L-6 Lot Joe & Fran Lowenstein sale pending
Q-7 Lot Charles & Laura Leggott $42,500
S-6 Lot David & Anne Barrow $63,900
D-7 House Steve & Irene Eckstrand $239,900
G-4 House David Andleman & Katherine Smiley $142,500

THROUGH COOLFONT REALTY (Sam Ashelman 304-258-4500)

B-4 & B-5 House and lot Bill & Donna Candreva $129,000
C-2 House Elaine Anderson & Lorraine Kujawa $145,000
E-3 Lot Evelyn Cate $35,000
R-1 Lot Kurt & Pat Schenk $75,000
Options are being taken on the T-Section now